BETTER FABRIC GUIDE

CERTIFICATIONS TO LOOK FOR:

CHOOSE THESE

TIER 1 — BEST CHOICES

ORGANIC COTTON (GOTS)
Breathable, skin-safe, full chain certified

HEMP
No pesticides, antimicrobial, gets softer

LINEN (flax)
Temp-regulating, low-spray crop

WOOL (MERINO) (ZQ/RWS)
Moisture-wicking, odour-resistant, biodegrades

SILK
Protein fibre, hypoallergenic, temp-regulating

TIER 2 — GOOD (WITH CAVEATS)

TENCEL™ LYOCELL (Lenzing)
Closed-loop process, biodegradable

BAMBOO LYOCELL
Cleaner than bamboo viscose

RECYCLED NATURAL FIBRES
Wool/cotton offcuts — lower footprint

Learn more @ lightenyourload.info

AVOID THESE

HIGHEST CONCERN

POLYESTER
Microplastics, phthalates, BPA*

NYLON (Polyamide)
Petroleum-derived, microplastic shedding

ACRYLIC
Plastic in fibre form — no biodegradability

CONVENTIONAL COTTON
10%~16% of world insecticides, pesticide residue

VISCOSE/RAYON
Toxic solvent process (carbon disulfide)

WATCH OUT FOR CHEMICAL FINISHES

PFAS / DWR coatings
Water-repellent, stain-resistant finishes

Antimicrobial treatments
Triclosan, silver — check activewear

Wrinkle-resistant finishes
Formaldehyde-releasing resins



* athletic/spandex blends & certain finishing processes